

INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Economics

BUSINESS FINANCE SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of productivity.
2. Analyze impact of specialization/division of labor on productivity.
3. Discuss the impact of a nation's unemployment rates.
4. Explain the role of business in society.
5. Identify project benefits and costs.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of the chief operating officer and the chief people officer at HARBORVIEW BANK, a community bank with 38 branches and 620 employees in and around the city of Port Calloway. The chair of the board of directors (judge) wants your team to recommend whether HARBORVIEW should adopt an artificial intelligence (AI) platform and, if so, how.

A financial technology vendor has proposed an AI platform that would review consumer loan applications, answer about 70% of customer service calls and chats, and flag possible fraud in real time. The vendor estimates that loan decisions would drop from three business days to under 20 minutes and that the bank could operate with about 90 fewer positions (roughly 15% of its workforce) within 18 months. Larger regional banks and online lenders already use similar tools and have been winning HARBORVIEW's younger customers with faster service.

The timing is sensitive. Port Calloway's largest employer, a regional distribution center, recently automated its warehouse and laid off 400 workers. The county unemployment rate has risen from 3.9% to 5.6% in one year, well above the national average. HARBORVIEW is the city's second-largest employer, and several local leaders have publicly urged businesses to "keep jobs in Port Calloway." HARBORVIEW is also starting to see more late payments on consumer loans.

The board will vote on the proposal next month. The chair (judge) wants your team to:

- Explain how the AI platform would affect productivity and the way work is divided at the bank.
- Discuss how rising local unemployment affects the community, the local economy and HARBORVIEW itself.
- Identify the benefits and costs of the project, financial and non-financial.
- Explain HARBORVIEW's role and responsibilities as a business in the community.
- Make a recommendation, including a plan for employees whose jobs would be affected.

You will present your recommendation to the chair of the board (judge) in a meeting in the boardroom. The chair (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your recommendation. After you have presented and answered the chair's (judge's) questions, the chair (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. If we decide not to adopt AI and our competitors keep using it, what happens to HARBORVIEW in five years?
2. A city council member says on the news that HARBORVIEW is "abandoning the town that built it." How should we respond?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of productivity.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Analyze impact of specialization/division of labor on productivity.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Discuss the impact of a nation's unemployment rates.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Explain the role of business in society.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Identify project benefits and costs.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	